

Kudzaishe George Zharare

Software & AI Engineer

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Software engineer and MIT graduate with hands-on delivery and technical leadership across backend systems, payments, identity, and applications. Experience leading identity and compliance engineering at Cleva and serving as CTO at FlexID. Building AI integrations and authorization workflows at Poza.

TECHNICAL FOCUS

Backend: TypeScript, Node.js, Python, Django, AWS, PostgreSQL, DynamoDB, Redis.

Applications: React, React Native, Android, web and mobile onboarding.

Systems: API integrations, identity verification, compliance rules, LLM integrations, structured tools, authorization, observability.

EXPERIENCE

Lead Engineer | Cleva (YC W24)

2023 to 2025

Led security, identity, and compliance engineering for a USD banking platform supporting 500,000+ users. Built automated KYC, liveness verification, transaction monitoring, resilient onboarding, and internal mobile-testing systems.

CTO, later Co-Founder | FlexID

2021 to 2023

Built a self-sovereign identity wallet across Android, web, and WhatsApp using Algorand, verifiable credentials, zero-knowledge proofs, and MPC key management. FlexID was selected as a World Economic Forum Technology Pioneer.

Founder | Motapa, trading as Mutapa

2019 to 2021

Built commerce and payment infrastructure, delivered integrations for 200 Zimbabwean merchants and institutions, and sold Mutapa Marketplace to CBZ Holdings. The marketplace continues as Zikimall.

Country Lead Engineer | The World Bank

2019 to 2020

Built Zimbabwe's DRIVER crash-reporting app and national dashboards. Led rollout with police, ambulance services, and the Ministry of Health.

SELECTED CURRENT WORK

Poza | Founder | 2025 to Present. Building financial applications, provider integrations, and an authorization layer for agent-proposed actions. Product and pilot development are ongoing. poza.co

Lalela Web Games. A browser platform adapting 202 GCompris educational activities with a shared JavaScript game framework. [Source and documentation](#)

EDUCATION

Massachusetts Institute of Technology | B.S. Computer Science & Math.
Undergraduate research in the Computational Fabrication Group, MIT CSAIL.